

## BEING ONLINE CAN BOOST YOUR CHANCES OF BEING IN LOVE

Net connections aren't just good for studies or research. Apparently, you have more chances of finding that special someone if you're surfing the web. In the US that is...

<http://bit.ly/b87ChW>

## GOOGLE UNDER PROBE IN S.KOREA OVER DATA COLLECTION

The Street View cars can take more than pictures it seems, and might actually be taking personal info from personal Wi-Fi networks... or so the South Korean police thought when they raided Google's offices.

<http://bit.ly/cIMTST>

## TRANSFORM ANY SURFACE INTO AN INTERACTIVE TOUCHSCREEN

The pic says it all...



<http://bit.ly/bMmnTi>

## THE WEB IS DEAD LONG LIVE THE INTERNET

Wired editor Chris Anderson and Michael Wolff look at the decline in proportions of US "web" traffic, and predict the end of the net as we know it. We don't necessarily agree, but read the article and decide for yourself...

<http://bit.ly/bknmCP>

packages later; a decision now won't prevent you from changing your mind down the road.

MythTV was an easy choice. For the uninitiated, MythTV is open-source DVR software that's been under development for about eight years. It's tougher to set up than Windows Media Center, but in some ways it's more powerful. For example, you can customize channel guides. This way, you don't have to stare at channels you don't receive with your cable package, and you can hide ones you're not interested in. If you're like me, you can hide all the standard-definition channels, and all the sports channels, for example. MythTV also lets you remove commercials from recordings automatically.

That said, there are plenty of other media center packages available for Linux. XBMC is arguably more attractive, and definitely better at organizing your standalone media. Enna, which runs on top of GeeXboX, is prettier still, and can scour the Web automatically for album covers, song lyrics, fan art, and other related information. Boxee is great for streaming Netflix, and it was great for streaming Hulu for a while. None of those options lets you record TV shows, though.

There's no other way to say it: Getting the installation right took plenty of trial and error. We'll report everything we ran into using the listed hardware and Mythbuntu distribution; this should make the process close to seamless for the reader. First, we built the computer using the parts as listed; this took just about half an hour. As part of the initial build, we installed the TV tuner card—in other words, even before we loaded the OS.

Next, we prepared an 8GB USB key for the regular Ubuntu 10.04 OS, using the awesome procedure outlined at [www.ubuntu.org](http://www.ubuntu.org). We used a nearby PC to set up the key. We selected the 32-bit version of Ubuntu for this install; digging for 64-bit drivers for TV tuner cards didn't seem like much fun, so we bypassed the issue.

Installing Ubuntu 10.04 from a USB key took less than 15 minutes, required minimal dialog boxes, and worked perfectly on the first shot.

Once the installation completed, I made sure everything was live, including the network connection and sound; it was. I installed Google Chrome, browsed the Web, logged into Pandora, and heard music. Excellent. At this point, the system said that Ubuntu still needed to install 237 updates totaling 187.8MB. (Has Ubuntu been hanging out with Windows 7? Yikes.) Anyway, that process took about 15 minutes more. After the updates finished installing, we headed to Mythbuntu.



com -> Downloads -> Add to Existing Ubuntu Install and installed the Mythbuntu package on top of our new Ubuntu system.

## MythTV and Remote Control

Setting up MythTV requires several main steps. As Heitmueller put it to us, setting up MythTV under Linux is a bit of "configuration overload," though it's easily worth the effort in the end. The basic idea involves several main goals, which surround three main pieces: Mythbuntu's Control Center, which defines the basic MythTV install; the MythTV Backend setup, which involves getting the TV tuner card online and populating the channel guide; and the MythTV live front end, which lets you schedule recordings and set up the remote control. There are way too many steps to reiterate here, but we found everything we

needed at the following four links:

Ubuntu 10.04: [www.ubuntu.org](http://www.ubuntu.org) | Mythbuntu 10.04: [www.mythbuntu.org](http://www.mythbuntu.org) | MythTV wiki: [wiki.mythtv.org](http://wiki.mythtv.org) | Hauppauge HVR-1600 wiki: [http://www.mythtv.org/wiki/Hauppauge\\_HVR-1600](http://www.mythtv.org/wiki/Hauppauge_HVR-1600). (There's also an extremely helpful IRC channel: [irc.freenode.net: channel #mythtv-users](http://irc.freenode.net/channel/#mythtv-users))

Originally, MythTV was designed to utilize separate machines for the backend (DVR) and front-end (user interface) roles. For this build, we'll set our one PC to do both. First, we'll need to configure Mythbuntu itself. Under System -> Administration -> Mythbuntu Control Center -> System Roles, check off both Primary Backend and Frontend, and leave Ubuntu Desktop checked along the bottom row. Then click Apply, and leave the default choices intact as you work your way through the process. During the install, we set a password for root, but it's not required. We also left it as the only MythTV system running (which was the default setting).

The next step is to configure the MythTV backend. Head to System -> Administration -> MythTV Backend Setup. Leave General Settings alone, as there isn't really anything worth changing there. Instead, choose Capture Cards; the system should find the Hauppauge HVR-1600 automatically, but it will incorrectly identify it as a V4L card. Change the top setting to IVTV MPEG-2 encoder card, since it's receiving compressed video. Leave all of the other settings intact and click Finish. (If the Finish button is tucked behind the task bar, make sure to auto-hide the task bar by right-clicking it and choosing auto-hide.)

In order for TV recording to work properly, you'll need some channel guides. The best way to do it is via [schedulesdirect.org](http://schedulesdirect.org), which costs \$20 per year. A seven-day free trial is available, and the trial doesn't require a credit card. This way you can make sure this project is for you before committing. When you set up the